

4 The centre-assessed units (R002-R007)

This section provides guidance on the completion of the centre-assessed units.

4.1 The centre-assessed units

Each of the centre-assessed units (R002–R007) is designed to provide learners with the opportunity to build a portfolio of evidence to meet the learning outcomes for that unit.

We recommend that teaching and development of subject content and associated skills be referenced to real vocational situations, through the utilisation of appropriate industrial contact, vocationally experienced delivery personnel, and real-life case studies.

Units R002–R007 are centre-assessed and externally-moderated by OCR. Centres can choose whether they would like moderation via the OCR Repository or postal moderation.

Appendix B of this specification contains assessment guidance for the centre-assessed units, which should be referred to in conjunction with the unit content and marking criteria grids to inform delivery of the units. The assessment guidance aims to provide clarification regarding the scope of the learning required in specific areas of the units where this is felt to be beneficial.

4.2 Tasks for the centre-assessed units

4.2.1 Units R002-R007

A bank of OCR-set assignments is provided by OCR for units R002–R007. Centres must select from the OCR-set assignments provided to use when assessing their learners. The assignments are available free of charge from the OCR website. Learners are able to work on the tasks anytime until the date the centre collects the work for internal assessment. OCR will review the OCR-set assignments annually which may result in an assignment being withdrawn and replaced. It is up to the centre to check the OCR website to see which assignments are available to be used. We will give approximately 12 months' notice if an assignment is to be withdrawn and replaced so that we do not disadvantage any learners who have already started working on an assignment that is to be replaced.

For some OCR-set assignments, centres may be able to make modifications. Guidance on what can be modified is given in each assignment in the section Teacher Information under *Scope of permitted changes*. Please ensure you use the latest version of the assignments. If modifications are made to the assignment, whether to just the scenario or to both the scenario and tasks, it is up to the centre to ensure that all learning outcomes can be met and that learners can assess the full range of marks.

For R002:

The assessment is structured so that learners are required to provide evidence of using appropriate ICT techniques to meet specified purposes. It is unlikely that evidence of the techniques used will, on their own, provide sufficient evidence to judge the extent to which they have been used appropriately. Annotations may help to provide this additional context and guidance on producing evidence is given in the OCR assignment for the unit.

Learners must be provided with access to an appropriate range of software that fully meets the requirements of this unit when they are taking their assessment. Learners must have access to a range of software as they must make their own decisions as to the choice of software and the techniques to be used when carrying out activities to generate assessment evidence. For example, learners should have access to both word processing and desk top publishing software and must be free to choose for themselves the most appropriate software to use in order to format/create documents which meet a specified purpose.

Learners must also make their own decisions when formatting/creating content. For example, learners must start with blank documents and then choose an appropriate layout as well as the techniques they will use to import, create and edit content – using wizards will not be appropriate. Similarly, this will apply to their use of spreadsheet and databases.

The duration of the assessment is included in the guided learning hours for the unit. Tasks should indicate how long learners should expect to spend on each task.

The OCR-set assignments are provided for summative assessment and not as practice materials.

Teachers must ensure learners are clear about the tasks they are to undertake and the criteria which they are expected to meet.

4.2.2 Methods of assessment

It is the assessor's responsibility to choose the best method of assessing a learner in relation to their individual circumstances. The methods chosen must be:

- valid
- reliable
- safe and manageable and
- suitable to the needs of the learner.

Valid

Validity can be compromised if a learner does not understand what is required of them. For example, one valid method of assessing a learner's knowledge and understanding is to question them. If the questions posed are difficult for the learner to understand (not in terms of the content but the way they are phrased, for example) the validity of the assessment method is questionable.

As well as assessment methods being valid, the evidence presented must also be valid. For example, it would not be appropriate to present an organisation's equal opportunities policy as evidence towards a learner's understanding of how the equal opportunities policy operates within the organisation. It would be more appropriate for the learner to incorporate the policy within a report describing different approaches to equal opportunities.

Reliable

A reliable method of assessment will produce consistent results for different assessors on each assessment occasion. Internal moderators must make sure that all assessors' decisions are consistent.

Safe and manageable

Assessors and internal moderators must make sure that the assessment methods are safe and manageable and do not put unnecessary demands on the learner.

Suitable to the needs of the learner

OCR is committed to ensuring that achievement of these awards is free from unnecessary barriers. Centres must follow this commitment through when designing tasks and/or considering assessment.

4.3 Completing the tasks

Teachers/assessors are expected to supervise and guide learners when undertaking work that is centre-assessed. It should be remembered, however, that the final pieces of work must be produced solely by the individual learner.

When supervising tasks, teachers/assessors are expected to:

- exercise continuing supervision of work in order to monitor progress and to prevent plagiarism
- exercise continuing supervision of practical work to ensure essential compliance with Health and Safety requirements
- ensure that the work is completed in accordance with the specification requirements and can be assessed in accordance with the specified marking criteria and procedures.

Centre-assessed work should be completed in the course of normal curriculum time, and supervised and marked by the teacher/assessor. Some of the work, by its very nature, may be undertaken outside the centre, for example, research work, testing etc. As with all centre-assessed work, the teacher must be satisfied that the work submitted for assessment is the learner's own.

Learners are free to revise and redraft work without teacher/assessor involvement before submitting the work for assessment. The advice provided prior to final submission should only enable the learner to take the initiative in making amendments, rather than detailing what amendments should be made. This means that teachers/assessors must not provide templates, model answers or detail specifically what amendments should be made.

Adding, amending or removing any work after it has been submitted for final assessment will constitute malpractice.

4.3.1 Presentation of the final piece of work

Learners must observe the following procedures when producing their final piece of work for the centre-assessed tasks:

- work can be word processed or hand written
- tables, graphs and spreadsheets may be produced using appropriate ICT. These should be inserted into the report at the appropriate place
- any copied material must be suitably acknowledged
- quotations must be clearly marked and a reference provided wherever possible
- a completed cover sheet must be attached to work submitted for moderation. The cover sheet must include the following information as well as the marks given for each of the assessment criteria:
 - centre number
 - centre name

- candidate number
- candidate name
- unit code and title
- assignment title.

Work submitted in digital format (CD or online) for moderation or marking must be in a suitable file structure as detailed in Appendix C at the end of this specification. Work submitted on paper must be secured by treasury tags or other suitable method.

4.4 Marking and moderating centre-assessed units

All centre-assessed units are internally marked by centre staff using OCR marking criteria and guidance and externally moderated by the OCR-appointed moderator.

The centre is responsible for appointing someone to act as the assessor. This could be the teacher who has delivered the programme or another person from the centre.

The marking criteria must be used to mark the learners' work. These specify the levels of skills, knowledge and understanding that the learner is required to demonstrate.

The following assessment methods are considered suitable for teachers/assessors to adopt for these qualifications alongside the assessment of the evidence submitted by the learner:

- **observation** of a learner doing something
- **questioning** of the learner or witness.

Observation

The teacher/assessor and learner should plan observations together but it is the teacher/assessor's responsibility to record the observation properly.

Questioning

Questioning the learner is normally an ongoing part of the assessment process, and may in some circumstances provide evidence to support achievement of learning outcomes.

Questioning is often used to:

- test a learner's understanding of work which has been completed outside of the classroom
- check if a learner understands the work they have undertaken
- collect information on the type and purpose of the processes a learner has gone through.

If questioning is to be used as evidence towards achievement of specific learning outcomes, it is important that teachers/assessors record enough information about what they asked and how the learner replied, to allow the assessment decision to be moderated.

Questioning witnesses is normally an ongoing part of validating written witness statements. However, questioning witnesses can be used for other purposes. Teachers/assessors should be able to speak to witnesses and record, in whatever way is suitable, the verbal statements of these witnesses. A record of a verbal statement is a form of witness statement and could provide valuable evidence. Further guidance on the use of witness statements can be found in Appendix A.

4.4.1 Use of a 'best fit' approach to marking criteria

The assessment tasks should be marked by teachers/assessors according to the OCR marking criteria using a 'best fit' approach. For each of the marking criteria, teachers/assessors select the band descriptor provided in the marking grid that most closely describes the quality of the work being marked.

Marking should be positive, rewarding achievement rather than penalising failure or omissions.

The award of marks **must be** directly related to the marking criteria.

- Each band descriptor covers all the relevant content for the learning outcomes.
- The descriptors should be read and applied as a whole.
- Make a best fit match between the answer and the band descriptors.
- An answer does not have to meet all of the requirements of a band descriptor before being placed in that band. It will be placed in a particular band when it meets more of the requirements of that band than it meets the requirements of other bands.

When deciding the mark within a band, the following criteria should be applied:

- the extent to which the statements within the band have been achieved.

For example:

- an answer that convincingly meets nearly all of the requirements of a band descriptor should be placed at or near the top of that band. Where the learner's work convincingly meets the statement, the highest mark should be awarded
- an answer that meets many of the requirements of the band descriptor should be placed in the middle of the band. Where the learner's work adequately meets the statement, the most appropriate mark in the middle range should be awarded
- if an answer is on the border-line between two bands but it is decided that it fits better the descriptors for the lower of these two bands, then it should be placed near the top of that band. Where the learner's work just meets the statement, the lowest mark should be awarded.

Teachers/assessor should use the full range of marks available to them and award full marks in any band for work that fully meets that descriptor. This is work that is 'the best one could expect from learners working at that level'.

4.4.2 Annotation of learners' work

Each piece of internally assessed work should show how the marks have been awarded in relation to the marking criteria.

The writing of comments on learners' work, and cover sheet, provides a means of communication between teachers during the internal standardisation and with the moderator if the work forms part of the moderation sample.

4.5 Authentication

Teachers/assessors must be confident that the work they mark is the learner's own. This does not mean that a learner must be supervised throughout the completion of all work, but the teacher must exercise sufficient supervision, or introduce sufficient checks, to be in a position to judge the authenticity of the learner's work.

Wherever possible, the teacher should discuss work-in-progress with learners. This will not only ensure that work is underway in a planned and timely manner, but will also provide opportunities for teachers/assessors to check authenticity of the work.

Learners must not plagiarise. Plagiarism is the submission of another's work as one's own and/or failure to acknowledge the source correctly. Plagiarism is considered to be malpractice and could lead to the learner being disqualified. Plagiarism sometimes occurs innocently when learners are unaware of the need to reference or acknowledge their sources. It is therefore important that centres ensure that learners understand that the work they submit must be their own and that they understand the meaning of plagiarism and what penalties may be applied. Learners may refer to research, quotations or evidence but they must list their sources. The rewards from acknowledging sources, and the credibility they will gain from doing so, should be emphasised to learners as well as the potential risks of failing to acknowledge such material.

Both learners and teachers must declare that the work is the learner's own.

- **Each learner** must sign a declaration before submitting their work to their teacher. A candidate authentication statement that can be used is available to download from the OCR website. These statements should be retained within the centre until all enquiries about results, malpractice and appeal issues have been resolved. **A mark of zero must be recorded if a learner cannot confirm the authenticity of their work.**
- **Teachers** are required to declare the work submitted for internal assessment is the candidate's own work by completing a centre authentication form (CCS160) for each unit. Centre authentication forms should be retained within the centre until all post-results issues have been resolved.

4.5.1 Internal standardisation

It is important that all teachers/assessors work to common standards. Centres must ensure that, within each unit, the internal standardisation of marks across teachers/assessors and teaching groups takes place using an appropriate procedure.

This can be done in a number of ways. In the first year, reference material and OCR training meetings will provide a basis for centres' own standardisation. In subsequent years, this, or centres' own archive material, may be used. Centres are advised to hold preliminary meetings of staff involved to compare standards through cross-marking a small sample of work. After most marking has been completed, a further meeting at which work is exchanged and discussed will enable final adjustments to be made.

4.5.2 Submitting marks

All work for centre assessment is marked by the teacher and internally standardised by the centre. Marks are then submitted to OCR; see Section 4.6 for submission dates of the marks to OCR.

There should be clear evidence that work has been attempted and some work produced. If a learner submits no work for a centre-assessed unit, then the learner should be indicated as being absent from that unit. If a learner completes any work at all for a centre-assessed unit, then the

work should be assessed according to the marking criteria and the appropriate mark awarded, which may be zero.

4.6 Moderation

The purpose of external moderation is to ensure that the standard of marking is the same for each centre and to ensure that internal standardisation has taken place.

Centres can select from:

- **Moderated via OCR Repository (see section 4.6.1)**
- **Moderated via postal moderation (see section 4.6.2)**

The deadline dates for entries and submission of marks for each moderation method are detailed below. Centres must ensure when selecting a moderation method that the appropriate entry and marks submission deadlines can be adhered to.

Moderation method	January Series		June Series		November Series	
	Entries	Marks	Entries	Marks	Entries	Marks
Moderated via OCR Repository	21st Oct	10th Jan	21st Feb	15th May	4th Oct	5th Nov
Moderated via postal moderation	21st Oct	10th Jan	21st Feb	15th May	4th Oct	5th Nov

When making your entries, the entry option specifies how the work is going to be moderated.

For each unit, you must choose the same moderation method for **all** learners (i.e. all learners for that unit in that series must be entered using the same entry option). However, you can choose different moderation methods for different units and in different series.

Sample requests

Once you have submitted your marks, your exams officer will receive an email telling you which work will be sampled as part of the moderation. Samples will include work from across the range of attainment of the learners' work.

Each learner's work must have a cover sheet attached to it with a summary of the marks awarded for the task. If the work is to be submitted via OCR Repository this cover sheet must also be submitted electronically within each learner's files.

OCR will require centres to release work for awarding and archive purposes and the co-operation of the centre is most appreciated in these instances, as it is imperative to have work available at awarding meetings. If this is required then centres will be notified as early as possible.

Centres will receive the final outcome of moderation when the provisional results are issued. The following reports will be issued via Interchange:

- Moderation adjustments report – This lists any scaling that has been applied to internally assessed units
- Moderator report to centres – This is a brief report by the moderator on the internal assessment of learners' work.

4.6.1 Moderated via OCR Repository

The OCR Repository is a secure website for centres to upload candidate work and for assessors to access this work digitally. Centres can use the OCR Repository for uploading marked candidate work for moderation.

Centres can access the OCR Repository via OCR Interchange, find their candidate entries in their area of the Repository, and use the Repository to upload files (singly or in bulk) for access by their moderator.

The OCR Repository allows candidates to produce evidence and files that would normally be difficult for postal submissions, for example multimedia and other interactive unit submissions.

The OCR Repository is seen as a faster, greener and more convenient means of providing work for assessment. It is part of a wider programme bringing digital technology to the assessment process, the aim of which is to provide simpler and easier administration for centres.

All moderated units can be submitted electronically to the OCR Repository via Interchange: please check section 7.2.2 for unit entry codes for the OCR Repository.

There are three ways to load files to the OCR Repository:

1. Centres can load multiple files against multiple candidates by clicking on 'Upload candidate files' in the Candidates tab of the Candidate Overview screen.
2. Centres can load multiple files against a specific candidate by clicking on 'Upload files' in the Candidate Details screen.
3. Centres can load multiple administration files by clicking on 'Upload admin files' in the Administration tab of the Candidate Overview screen.

Instructions for how to upload files to OCR using the OCR Repository can be found on [OCR Interchange](#).

4.6.2 Moderated via postal moderation

Your sample of work must be posted to the moderator within three days of receiving the request. You should use one of the labels provided by OCR to send the learner's work.

We would advise you to keep evidence of work submitted to the moderator, e.g. copies of written work or photographs of practical work. You should also obtain a certificate of posting for all work that is posted to the moderator.

Work may be submitted in digital format (on CD) for moderation but must be in a suitable file structure as detailed in Appendix C at the end of this specification.